

EMBASSY SECRETARY BACK FROM RUSSIA

Norman Armour Tells of the
Horrors of the Bolshevist
Regime in Petrograd.

THE POPULATION STARVING

Red Guards More Murderous and
Autocratic Than Any Agency
of the Days of the Czars.

AN ATLANTIC PORT, Nov. 5.—A British liner arrived today from England with 225 passengers, making the trip within six days, which was a record for wartime. The ship in making fast to the pier this morning bumped the pierhead and tore away some of the superstructure with her sharp stem. There was delay in getting the baggage from the hold because the 'longshoremen insisted on a full hour for luncheon at noon.

In the first cabin was a party of American officials from Russia, among them Norman Armour, Secretary of the United States Embassy; William C. Huntington, the Commercial Attaché, and Felix Willoughby Smith, former United States Consul at Tiflis. They are returning to Washington under orders of the State Department.

Speaking of conditions in Russia under the Bolshevist régime, Mr. Armour said the outside world had no conception of the terrible things that are occurring daily in Russia. "The conditions under the greatest tyrants in the time of the Czar," he said, "were never half so bad as they are today under the Bolsheviks. We were ordered out of Petrograd on July 23 with the other foreign diplomats and consular officers, and were sent to Vologda. We were often ordered to leave that place, but stayed on because there were ten employees of the National City Bank and a lot of money and valuables that needed protection. The Bolsheviks attacked the British Embassy and killed the Naval Attaché because he would not obey orders, and frequent attacks were made on our party of Americans, but we stood them off.

"Our hope was that help would come to us from Archangel. Toward the end of August the Bolsheviks covered our building with machine guns, and when night came, swooped down on us, carried our effects into the streets and took us to the railroad station, where a special train was waiting to carry the party to the frontier. A wide detour was made to avoid entering Petrograd."

Mr. Armour said he had a Norwegian passport, and got back to Petrograd, disguised as a dispatch bearer for the Norwegian Government.

"I found the principal building closed," he said, "and the entire city seemed deserted. The Bolshevist guards were out in force, and their attitude toward the public was more autocratic than anything ever perpetrated in the name of the Czar. Words are inadequate to describe what I saw in Russia during this reign of terror, misery, want and wholesale murder. The people are starving and can get no hearing, much less redress, from the blood-crazed Bolsheviks."

As an illustration of food conditions in Petrograd, Mr. Armour told of seeing an emaciated cab horse die in the shafts, and of hungry men and women cutting up and carrying away the carcass.

Mr. Armour refused to discuss movements of the allied forces in Russia or Siberia.